

Recap Checkpoint 3 — after 1.4 (Data Types, Data Structures & Boolean Algebra) — cumulative 1.1–1.4

Name: _____ Date: _ **Mark:** _____ / 42

OCR H446 cumulative recap — mixes every topic taught so far. Show all working.

Questions

Q1. State **one** difference between **CISC** and **RISC** processors, referring to the instruction set. **[2]** (AO1)
— 1.1.2

Q2. Explain what is meant by **virtual memory** and give **one** drawback of relying on it heavily. **[3]**
(AO1/AO2) — 1.2.1

Q3. Place the four stages of compilation in the correct order, and name the stage that **removes redundant instructions to make the object code more efficient**: *code generation, lexical analysis, optimisation, syntax analysis*. **[3]** (AO1) — 1.2.2

Q4. A company hashes stored passwords but **encrypts** the customer data it transmits. Explain, referring to the **key difference between hashing and encryption**, why each technique is appropriate for its purpose. **[3]** (AO2) — 1.3.1

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Q5. Convert the denary number **89** into: (a) 8-bit binary **[1]** (AO2)

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(b) hexadecimal **[2]** (AO2)

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Show your working. **[3 total]** — 1.4.1

Q6. Using **8-bit two's complement**, calculate **39 – 52**. You must: (a) show 39 and 52 in 8-bit binary **[1]** (AO2)

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(b) form the two's complement of 52 **[1]** (AO2)

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(c) perform the addition and state the final **denary** result **[2]** (AO2)

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[4 total] — 1.4.1

Q7. A floating point value is shown as **0.0001101** × 2⁴ (mantissa with the point after the sign bit, exponent in denary). (a) Normalise the mantissa and state the new exponent. **[2]** (AO2)

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(b) Explain **why** numbers are normalised. **[1]** (AO1)

[3 total] — 1.4.1

Q8. Simplify the Boolean expression $A \cdot (\bar{A} + B)$ using Boolean identities. Show each step and name the identities used. [3] (AO2) — 1.4.3

Q9. Complete the truth table for $F = (A + B) \cdot \neg(A \cdot B)$ and state which single logic gate it is equivalent to. [4] (AO2) — 1.4.3

A	B	F
0	0	
0	1	
1	0	
1	1	

Q10. A **stack** (implemented in an array) is initially empty. The following operations are applied in order: push 8, push 3, push 5, pop, push 9, pop. (a) State the value returned by **each** pop operation. [2] (AO3)

(b) State the contents of the stack (bottom → top) after all operations, and explain why a stack is described as **LIFO**. [2] (AO3)

Q12. An embedded controller for a heart-rate monitor must store readings, process them in real time, and use as little power as possible. The design team must justify, **synoptically**, three decisions: the **processor architecture (RISC vs CISC)**, an appropriate **data structure** to buffer the most recent readings, and whether to use a **lossy or lossless** compression scheme before transmitting stored readings to a doctor. Evaluate suitable choices for **all three**, justifying each against the device's requirements. **[6]** (AO3) — *synoptic 1.1 + 1.4 + 1.3*

[illegible]